SRI - EPNU: Study Design Decision Chart

Observational vs Experimental Designs Reference

1. Did the investigator assign the exposure?
   -> YES: Experimental Study (Randomized Controlled Trial / Quasi-Experimental)
   -> NO: Observational Study
2. Is there a comparison group?
   -> YES: Analytical Study (Cohort, Case-Control, Cross-Sectional)
   -> NO: Descriptive Study (Case Report, Case Series)
3. Direction of inquiry:
   -> Exposure to Outcome (Forward): Cohort Study (Measure: Relative Risk)
   -> Outcome to Exposure (Backward): Case-Control Study (Measure: Odds Ratio)
   -> Same point in time (Snapshot): Cross-Sectional Study (Measure: Prevalence)